GROVEN

A Typed Idea Graph for Collaborative Thinking & Collective Governance

Open Source Initiative · March 2026

Initiated by Sofilab GmbH, Munich
Co-funded by the European Union (Creative Europe)

The Problem with Existing Platforms

Why current tools fail for governance

Engagement ≠ Deliberation

Likes, feeds, and view counts reward provocation over precision. A reaction outperforms a synthesis. Platforms aren't broken — they're working as designed. Just not for governance.

All Contributions Look Equal

A comment that sharpens an idea is indistinguishable from one that misses the point entirely. The platform doesn't distinguish. At scale, the reasoning disappears into noise.

Memory Loss over Time

A forum thread from six months ago is unreadable as a document. The reasoning behind governance decisions becomes irrecoverable. Accountability requires legibility.

The Solution

Groven makes the growth of ideas visible.

It is a communication platform for communities that need to move from open discussion to informed collective decision — without losing the reasoning that got them there.

Structured

Seed → Branch → Forest

Typed

LLM classifies every contribution

Governed

Discussion leads to binding decisions

Seed → Branch → Forest

A Git-inspired model for idea lineage

SEED

A contribution that introduces an idea, question, or position. Always text — optionally with images, drawings, video, or links. The root node of every thread.

BRANCH

A contribution that explicitly builds on a Seed or Branch. Has exactly one parent and inherits its lineage. Requires a brief description: what does this build on, and where does it take the argument?

FOREST

The growing network of all Seeds and Branches. The living memory of the community — searchable, filterable, and permanently archived. Governance decisions are anchored here as immutable nodes.

Branch Typology

Not all contributions are equal — Groven makes the difference visible

Clarification

Sharpens a vague idea. Does not add new content.

Extension

Carries the idea into territory the Seed did not anticipate.

Reframing

Same idea, fundamentally different angle. Does not contradict.

Contradiction

Identifies a conflict. Proposes a divergent direction. A Fork.

Synthesis

Connects two or more Branches that diverged. Reconciles lines of thought.

The "Contested" Signal

When the LLM proposes a type and the author selects a different one, Groven generates a visible 'Contested' signal on that node.

This marks places where classification is uncertain -- where the community's norms around what counts as contradiction versus reframing are still being formed.

These are exactly the nodes most worth examining.

The LLM as Visible Structuring Assistant

Not a moderator. Not a recommender.
A semantic observer — visible, explainable, overridable.

WHAT IT DOES

- Reads every Branch with its parent and proposes a type
- Explains its classification in plain language
- Generates structured summaries for the governance body
- Signals where ideas have grown collectively

WHAT IT DOES NOT DO

- Steer conversations toward any outcome
- Hide or deprioritise any contribution
- Decide when a topic is ready for a vote
- Act without human review or override

The LLM proposes — the author decides.

Governance Module

Voting is not a separate tool — it is a state transition in the same graph

OPEN

Discussion is active. Seeds and Branches grow. Anyone with access can contribute.

READY

A designated body declares the topic ready. The LLM generates a structured summary. Discussion closes for new Branches.

DECIDED

Vote complete. Decision — with full breakdown and written justification — anchored as an immutable node in the Forest.

Minority positions are always recorded alongside the majority decision. The decision node is immutable and permanently linkable.

How Groven Differs

The combination that doesn't exist yet

Feature	Kialo / Pol.is	Loomio / Decidim	Groven
Idea lineage graph	Partial (tree only)	No	✓ Full ancestry
Branch typology	Pro/Con only	No	✓ 5 semantic types
LLM structuring assistant	No	No (limited AI)	✓ Visible + overridable
Voting in same graph	No	Partial	✓ State transition
Decision anchored in lineage	No	No	✓ Immutable node
Minority position recording	No	Partial	✓ Always required
Self-hostable open source	No	Yes / Partial	✓ Core commitment

Open Source Strategy

A governance tool must be transparent to be trusted

MIT License

Maximum reuse, including commercial use. Any organisation can self-host. Source code is always open.

Self-hostable

No mandatory cloud dependency. Any community can run their own Groven instance on their own infrastructure.

Governed by itself

Roadmap decisions made through public Groven discussions. RFCs use the Seed→Branch→Forest model natively.

CORPUS as reference

First and reference implementation. Validates the concept. But Groven has zero dependency on CORPUS — fully general-purpose.

First Use Case: CORPUS Royalty Protocol

Groven initiated within a real governance challenge

CORPUS is an open licensing and royalty infrastructure for music in the age of AI — developed by Sofilab GmbH, Munich, co-funded by the European Union (Creative Europe).

It requires a governance platform that can:

- Support deliberation among a curated contributor community selected by stratified sortition
- Make the reasoning behind governance decisions permanently legible
- Connect community discussion to formal voting without losing context
- Scale without losing the quality of structured deliberation

Groven is domain-agnostic. CORPUS is its first proof of concept.

CORPUS at a glance	
Status	Development / Pilot
Community	< 50 contributors (launch)
Selection	Stratified sortition
Governance	Sortition Jury model
Domain	Music & AI licensing
Funding	EU Creative Europe

Development Roadmap

From internal prototype to public open source release

Phase 0 M 1–2	Phase 1 M 3–4	Phase 2 M 5–6	Phase 3 M 7–8	Phase 4 M 9–10	Phase 5 M 11–12
Foundation Repo, data model, auth, basic Seed creation	**Seed→Branch→Forest** Branch creation, lineage graph, Forest visualisation	**LLM Integration** Type proposal, explanation, override, Contested signal	**Governance Module** Voting, Ready state, Decision node in Forest	**CORPUS Pilot** Production integration, sortition jury onboarding	**Public Release** v1.0 open source, docs, RFC process activated

Phase 6+: Audio/video support · Federation between Groven instances · Mobile interface · Community-driven roadmap

Groven is where structured thinking becomes collective action.

It is open source, self-hostable, and governed by the same tool it provides.

groven.github.io

Website & documentation

github.com/sofilab-art/groven

Source code & issues

Sofilab GmbH, Munich

Contact & collaboration

This slide is a Seed. Fork it.